FUTURES MATTER EDUCATION

Futures Matter - Northwood, 122 Emily Street, Highgate, Birmingham, B12 0XJ

Careers and Work-Related Learning Policy

Reference: FME-CU-02

Last review: October 2026
Next review: August 2027

Reviewed by: Benjamin Neasom, Head Teacher
Carrie-Ann McGurk, Proprietor
Mark O'Donnell, Chair of School Governance Board

1.0 INTRODUCTION AND VISION

We are passionate about helping our pupils to identify and achieve their ambitions. Whether a pupil wants to be an astronaut, an artist or does not yet know, we will help them understand their skills, talents and interests and the areas they are developing. We know pupils may change their minds, and our job is to equip them with the confidence, life skills and transferable skills to adapt to whatever comes, with a range of options and pathways.

We are responsible for making sure every pupil leaves us and continues in education, employment or training that is sustainable and right for them. This policy sets out how we provide careers education, information, advice and guidance (CEIAG) and work-related learning for pupils in Years 7 to 11. It should be read with our Work Experience Policy and Procedures.

2.0 LEGAL AND GUIDANCE FRAMEWORK

We meet the Independent School Standards, which require pupils to have access to accurate, up to date and impartial careers guidance that helps them make informed choices about a broad range of options. **[Head Teacher to confirm the Independent School Standards paragraph reference before publication]** Although some duties in the DfE statutory guidance Careers guidance and access for education and training providers (updated May 2025) apply to maintained schools, we follow it as our standard, and work towards the eight Gatsby Benchmarks (updated May 2025).

3.0 DEFINITIONS

Independent means external to the school. External sources include employer visits, mentoring, websites, helplines and personal guidance from outside the school. Taken together, they must cover the full range of education and training options, including apprenticeships and technical education.

Personal guidance can be given by trained school staff, but it must be added to by external sources of support.

Careers guidance means the whole range of activity under the eight Gatsby Benchmarks.

4.0 LEADERSHIP, GOVERNANCE AND TRAINING

The Head Teacher, Benjamin Neasom, is responsible for the quality of careers provision. Our Careers Leader is **[name and role]**, who is responsible for planning and running the programme, and can be contacted at **[email address and phone number]**. **[Confirm the Careers Leader has had, or will complete, the training and dedicated time expected for the role]**

The Head Teacher reports to the Proprietor and the Governance Board at least **[termly]** on: progress towards the Gatsby Benchmarks, training for lead staff, independent information, advice and guidance, the careers and work-related learning offer, employability skills, work experience and destinations. We assess our progress each year using **[Compass+ or an equivalent tool]** and set improvement targets.

5.0 THE GATSBY BENCHMARKS AT FUTURES MATTER - NORTHWOOD

- **1. A stable careers programme:** a planned programme, mapped to the Gatsby Benchmarks, with a named Careers Leader. A summary is published on our website and shared with pupils, parents, carers, staff and employers. It is evaluated each year.
- **2. Learning from career and labour market information:** pupils and parents use up to date information on careers, pay and local opportunities from the National Careers Service and Birmingham Careers Service, from Year 8.
- **3. Addressing the needs of each pupil:** careers advice is personal to each pupil, challenges stereotypes, takes account of SEND and their EHC plan, and is free from bias. We record guidance and keep destination data.
- **4. Linking curriculum learning to careers:** every subject shows how its content leads to real jobs, through Career Spotlight lessons or short activities, and through PSHCEE and tutor time.
- **5. Encounters with employers and employees:** pupils meet a wide range of employers and employees every year, including positive role models, through visitors, assemblies, mentoring and projects.
- **6. Experiences of workplaces:** every pupil has first-hand experience of a workplace by age 16, and we aim for at least two weeks of work experience activities across Years 7 to 11 (see our Work Experience Policy).
- **7. Encounters with further and higher education:** pupils learn about the full range of routes, including academic, technical and vocational courses, T Levels, apprenticeships, college, university and supported pathways, and visit colleges and providers.

- **8. Personal guidance:** every pupil has at least one guidance interview with a qualified careers adviser by the end of Year 11, and earlier where needed, with a record and a destination plan.

6.0 CAREERS ACROSS THE SCHOOL

We teach pupils from Year 7 to Year 11. Our programme introduces careers early to raise aspirations, challenge stereotypes and show that there are many options. Careers is taught through PSHCEE, tutor time, assemblies, the wider curriculum and enrichment, and is mapped in Appendix 1.

Years 7 to 9: pupils explore their interests and strengths, learn about the world of work, jobs and employment, money and enterprise, meet speakers, and take part in work-related activities such as tasters and virtual experiences. They begin to understand options at the end of Year 9.

Years 10 and 11: pupils receive individual guidance, take part in work experience, learn how to apply for courses and apprenticeships, visit colleges and providers, and complete a destination plan. The Careers Leader works with Tutors, parents and carers on each pupil's plan.

7.0 INDEPENDENT AND PERSONAL GUIDANCE

All pupils from Year 8 (age 12) have access to an impartial, independent careers adviser. Our adviser is **[name, organisation and qualification]**. Pupils with an EHC plan have guidance linked to their annual review and preparation for adulthood outcomes. Guidance is available at key transition points, and pupils or parents can ask for an interview at any time. We use Birmingham Careers Service and the National Careers Service as external sources.

8.0 PUPILS WITH SEND AND PREPARATION FOR ADULTHOOD

Our pupils have SEMH needs and autism, and many have an EHC plan. Our programme is personalised and uses small groups, clear and literal language, visual supports, advance warning of change, and trusted adults. We work with parents, carers, the local authority and colleges so pupils have the support they need to move on, including visits, transition plans, travel training and, where appropriate, supported pathways. We follow the preparation for adulthood outcomes of employment, independent living, community inclusion and health.

9.0 EDUCATION AND TRAINING PROVIDERS

We invite colleges, training providers and universities to speak to pupils about technical education, apprenticeships and other options, through assemblies, group discussions and tasters. Requests from providers are made to the Careers Leader, and our Provider Access Statement is published on our website. **[Careers Leader to write and publish the Provider Access Statement]** Provider visits are risk assessed and supervised.

10.0 WORK EXPERIENCE AND EMPLOYER ENGAGEMENT

Work experience is set out in our Work Experience Policy and Procedures. We build links with employers, offering speakers, visits, simulated briefs and placements. Employers are asked for feedback after each activity.

11.0 TRANSITION, DESTINATIONS AND TRACKING

Before leaving, every Year 11 pupil has a confirmed destination plan, with an offer in place where possible. We support applications, interviews and visits. We record each pupil's destination, and follow up for **[three]** years after they leave. If a pupil is at risk of not being in education, employment or training, we involve the local authority and the pupil's family early.

12.0 EQUALITY AND IMPARTIALITY

Careers provision is open to all pupils regardless of background or need, challenges gender and other stereotypes and respects the Equality Act 2010. Advice is impartial, and no pupil is steered towards a route because it suits the school or a provider.

13.0 PARENTS AND CARERS

We involve parents and carers in careers planning, through the EHC plan, reviews, parents' evenings and information on routes and labour market information. Parents and carers can contact the Careers Leader at any time.

14.0 PUBLICATION, EVALUATION AND REVIEW

We publish our careers programme on our website, including the Careers Leader's name and contact details, a summary of the programme, how we measure its impact and when it will next be reviewed. We evaluate the programme each year using pupil, parent and employer feedback and destination data. This policy is reviewed annually through our governance process.

15.0 REFERENCES

- Education (Careers Guidance in Schools) Act 2022
- Careers guidance and access for education and training providers, DfE statutory guidance (updated May 2025)
- Gatsby Benchmarks of Good Career Guidance (updated May 2025)
- Independent School Standards, DfE
- Skills for jobs: lifelong learning for opportunity and growth, DfE 2021
- Work experience and work-related activities in schools and colleges, DfE
- Birmingham Careers Service, National Careers Service and Apprenticeships (gov.uk)

16.0 APPENDIX 1: CAREERS PROGRAMME CURRICULUM MAP, YEARS 7 TO 11

The curriculum map is held in the school's Careers folder as the Careers Long-Term Plan. **[Careers Leader to complete the map for Years 8 to 11 and attach it here, with the Gatsby Benchmark each topic meets]**